Your Home Selling Guide

SELL WITH CONFIDENCE

A practical guide to preparing, pricing, marketing, negotiating and closing.

JLA Realty was founded in March 2011 by John Altic, President and CEO.
His passion and vision for real estate have inspired the creation of a powerful, respected team of agents.

John's drive to innovate and redefine what a traditional brokerage can be has fueled JLA Realty's remarkable growth.

As we continue to expand, our commitment to serving the community grows with us. This growth allows us to better meet the needs of our clients by offering a comprehensive range of real estate services.

Our clients consistently praise the expertise and professionalism of JLA Realty agents. Each agent is an industry expert dedicated to understanding clients' goals and exceeding their expectations—a philosophy that defines our success.

The broad range of services we provide continues to bring value to every real estate transaction.

At JLA Realty, we are ready and eager to assist you with all your real estate needs.

John Altic

President and CEO, JLA Realty



WELCOME

My goal is to make the selling process feel organized, informed and manageable from the first conversation to closing. Your Home is more than a listing; it is a major financial decision. I'll help you understand the steps, evaluate your options, and keep the process moving while you focus on your next chapter.

WHAT YOU CAN EXPECT FROM ME

- Clear communication and realistic expectations
- A thoughtful pricing conversation based on market information
- A property-specific marketing plan
- Guidance on preparation, showings, offers and negotiations
- Coordination with the professionals involved in the transaction
- Updates as activity and feedback develop

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

- Honest information about the property and its history
- Timely responses and documents when needed
- Access for photography, showings, inspections and other appointments
- Communication about repairs, improvements, tenants or special circumstances
- A willingness to review market feedback and adjust strategy when appropriate

A good listing starts before the listing goes live.

We'll talk through your timing, goals, property condition, likely buyer profile, pricing considerations and the work that is—or is not—worth doing before launch.

Table of Contents

A step-by-step seller resource

1. Welcome / What to Expect
2. The Selling Process — Start to Finish
3. Preparing Your Home for Market
4. Pricing Your Home
5. Your Marketing Plan
6. Showings & Open Houses
7. Understanding Offers
8. Once You're Under Contract
9. Inspections & Repairs
10. Texas Seller Disclosures
11. Title, Survey & Closing
12. Seller Costs & Net Proceeds
13. Moving Resources
14. Special Situations
15. Seller Questionnaire
16. Pre-Listing & Photo Checklist
17. Moving & Post-Closing Checklist
18. Seller FAQ

How to use this guide

Read it before your listing appointment, keep it nearby while your home is on the market and use the checklists when you need a quick reminder. Some transaction requirements vary by property and contract; your REALTOR®, title/escrow professionals, lender, attorney, or other appropriate professional can provide situation-specific guidance.

The Selling Process



1. Consultation
We discuss your goals, timing, property details, potential challenges, and what you want the sale to accomplish.

2. Prepare
Prioritize the improvements, cleaning, decluttering, staging and documentation that can help your home present well—without spending blindly.

3. Price
Review comparable properties and current market activity to establish a pricing strategy that fits your goals and the market.

4. List & Market
Launch the listing with professional presentation, MLS exposure, digital marketing, social media, agent-to-agent outreach and property-specific promotion.

5. Show & Evaluate
Manage showings, open houses when appropriate, and buyer feedback. Watch the activity—not just the number of showings—to understand what the market is telling us.

6. Offer → Contract → Closing
Evaluate offers beyond price, negotiate terms, move through inspections and other contract milestones, complete title and closing requirements and prepare for the final transfer.

Your strategy can change as the market responds.
A strong launch is important, but the job does not stop after the listing goes live. We use showing activity, feedback, competing listings and market changes to decide whether the strategy needs to be adjusted.

The Selling Process

STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS	YOUR ROLE
Consultation	Goals, timing, property review, pricing discussion, strategy.	Share your priorities and property information.
Preparation	Repairs, cleaning, decluttering, staging and photography planning.	Complete agreed preparation and protect valuables.
Launch	MLS entry, photos, marketing assets, online distribution.	Keep the home showing-ready.
Showings	Buyer appointments, open houses when appropriate, feedback.	Provide access and keep the home presentable.
Offers	Review price, financing, timing, contingencies and other terms.	Consider the full offer—not price alone.
Under Contract	Inspections, repair negotiations, financing/appraisal, title and other milestones.	Meet deadlines and make informed decisions.
Closing	Final documents, payoff/title work, final walkthrough and transfer.	Prepare to vacate, sign required documents and verify proceeds.

Preparing Your Home

Not every repair or renovation produces a meaningful return. Before committing to a major project, let's look at the condition of the home, the likely buyer expectations, comparable properties and the timing of your sale.

Declutter & Depersonalize	Reduce visual distractions, store excess furniture and make it easier for buyers to picture themselves in the home.
Deep Clean	Kitchens, bathrooms, windows, floors, appliances, baseboards and high-touch areas all matter.
Repairs & Maintenance	Address obvious deferred maintenance and safety concerns. Prioritize items that could create buyer hesitation.
Curb Appeal	Clean the entry, trim landscaping, clear walkways and make the first impression intentional.
Staging	Use the furnishings you have strategically or discuss professional staging when it makes sense.
Documentation	Gather surveys, warranties, permits, receipts, leases, HOA information, utility details and records that may help answer buyer questions.

Pre-listing inspection: pros & cons

Potential benefit: it may uncover issues early, giving you time to understand and address them.
Potential drawback: it adds a cost and can create additional information that may need to be considered in the transaction. Whether it makes sense depends on the property, timing and your goals.

Pre-listing Checklist

Use this as a practical starting point. We'll customize the priorities for your property.

- [ ] Remove excess furniture and personal items
- [ ] Store or remove valuable / sensitive items
- [ ] Clean windows, glass doors and mirrors
- [ ] Deep clean kitchen and bathrooms
- [ ] Touch up obvious paint issues
- [ ] Replace burned-out or mismatched bulbs
- [ ] Repair visible leaks, broken fixtures or damaged hardware
- [ ] Clean or refresh flooring as appropriate
- [ ] Trim landscaping and clear walkways
- [ ] Clean driveway, patio and entry
- [ ] Organize closets so they feel spacious
- [ ] Remove excess items from countertops
- [ ] Make beds and simplify bedrooms
- [ ] Put away pet supplies before photos/showings
- [ ] Gather warranties, permits and repair records
- [ ] Locate survey and title/closing documents if available
- [ ] Confirm HOA information and transfer requirements if applicable
- [ ] Discuss leased items such as solar, security or equipment
- [ ] Discuss any planned renovations before spending
- [ ] Create a showing plan for pets and valuables

The goal is not perfection.

The goal is to present the home cleanly, confidently and honestly—while protecting your time and avoiding unnecessary spending.

Pricing Your Home

Pricing is one of the most important decisions in a listing.
The recommended price should balance your goals with what the market is likely to support.

TERM	WHAT IT TELLS US
Sold Comparable	What buyers actually paid for similar properties. Sold data is especially important when establishing market value.
Pending	A property that is under contract can provide a useful signal about current buyer activity, although the final sale price may not yet be known.
Active	Your current competition. Active listings show what buyers can choose from today.
Days on Market	How long properties have taken to attract a buyer. Context matters: price, condition, location and market conditions all influence it.
Price Reduction	A strategic adjustment when the market response suggests the original price or positioning is not producing the desired activity.

CMA ≠ appraisal
A Comparative Market Analysis (CMA) is a REALTOR®'s market-based pricing analysis.
An appraisal is a professional valuation prepared for a specific purpose. They can use overlapping information, but they are not the same thing.

Why "testing the market" can backfire
A high starting price can reduce early activity, increase days on market, and make later price changes more difficult to interpret. A well-supported strategy gives the listing the best chance to attract serious attention when it is new

Your Marketing Plan

Marketing is not simply putting a property online. The objective is to make the home easy to discover, easy to understand, and compelling enough to earn the next step: a showing.

Professional Photography	High-quality images that present the home accurately and highlight its strongest features.
MLS Exposure	A complete, accurate listing designed to give buyers and agents the information they need.
Major Real Estate Websites	Broader online exposure through listing distribution and real estate search platforms.
Social Media	Property-specific content that can showcase features, lifestyle, video, updates, open houses and more.
Agent-to-Agent Marketing	Direct exposure to other real estate professionals and their buyer networks.
Open Houses	Used when appropriate based on the property, market, location and seller goals.
Signage	Clear property identification and calls to action where appropriate.
Database & Network	Sharing the opportunity with an existing network of contacts and potential buyers.
JLA Realty Reach	Leverage the brokerage's professional network and resources as part of the overall marketing effort.

Photography, Showings & Open Houses

Photo Preparation

- [ ] Turn on all interior lights and lamps
- [ ] Open blinds, shades and curtains as appropriate
- [ ] Clean windows and glass doors
- [ ] Remove clutter from countertops and surfaces
- [ ] Put away personal photos and sensitive documents
- [ ] Make beds and tidy bedrooms
- [ ] Clear bathroom counters and shower items
- [ ] Remove trash cans from sight
- [ ] Hide cords, chargers and small appliances where practical
- [ ] Move vehicles out of sight if possible
- [ ] Clean patios, walkways and outdoor living areas
- [ ] Put away garden tools, toys and pet items

Before You Leave For A Showing

- [ ] Lights on; temperature comfortable
- [ ] Blinds/curtains positioned to show natural light
- [ ] Beds made and rooms tidy
- [ ] Counters and sinks clear
- [ ] Valuables, medications and sensitive documents secured
- [ ] Pets safely handled according to the showing plan
- [ ] Trash and dishes out of sight
- [ ] Strong odors addressed

Feedback is information, not a verdict and not all agents will provide feedback.
Showing feedback can reveal what buyers notice, question or compare against other homes.
Patterns are more useful than one-off comments, and we can use those patterns to refine the strategy.

Understanding Offers

Marketing is not simply putting a property online. The objective is to make the home easy to discover, easy to understand and compelling enough to earn the next step: a showing.

FACTOR	QUESTION TO CONSIDER
Price	What is the proposed purchase price compared with the current market and your goals?
Financing	Cash or financed? What type of financing? How strong is the buyer's financial position based on the information available?
Down Payment / Earnest Money	What does the structure indicate about the buyer's commitment and transaction strength?
Option / Inspection Terms	What does the structure indicate about the buyer's commitment and transaction strength?
Concessions	Is the buyer requesting closing-cost assistance or other contributions, and what is the impact on your net?
Appraisal Risk	If financing is involved, what happens if the property does not appraise at the contract price?
Closing Date	Does the proposed date work with your next move, purchase, lease, or other commitments?
Leaseback / Possession	Do you need time after closing or any special possession arrangement?
Likelihood of Closing	How do all of the terms work together? A slightly lower offer may be stronger if it reduces risk or fits your timeline better.

A useful question to ask
"Which offer gives me the best combination of price, terms, certainty, and timing?"

Once You're Under Contract



What Happens Next?

- [ ] Review the contract and key deadlines
- [ ] Provide requested documents and information promptly
- [ ] Coordinate access for inspection and other appointments
- [ ] Review inspection findings and buyer requests
- [ ] Negotiate repairs, concessions, or other terms when appropriate
- [ ] Monitor buyer financing and appraisal milestones when applicable
- [ ] Complete title, payoff, survey, HOA and other transaction requirements as needed
- [ ] Prepare the home for final walkthrough and turnover
- [ ] Confirm closing logistics and required identification/documents

The inspection report may be long. Don't panic.
Inspection reports often contain many observations, from minor maintenance items to larger concerns.
The important step is to review the findings in context, understand what the buyer is requesting, and make informed decisions about the response.

Texas Seller Disclosures

Texas transactions can involve seller disclosures and property-specific notices. The exact documents and requirements depend on the property and circumstances. This guide is an educational overview—not legal advice—and should not be used to decide whether a particular disclosure is legally required.

Seller's Disclosure Notice	Provide truthful, complete information as required for your transaction and property circumstances. Your REALTOR® can help you understand the process, but legal questions should be directed to an appropriate professional.
Lead-Based Paint	Federal disclosure requirements can apply to certain residential properties built before 1978. Ask the appropriate professional about whether the requirements apply to your sale.
MUD / PID / Property Assessments	Certain properties may have special district, assessment or notice considerations. Verify property-specific information rather than assuming it applies.
Septic / Private Well	Properties with septic systems or private wells may involve additional records, inspections or notices. Gather available documentation early.
Flood / Water / Groundwater Information	Property location and water resources can create additional information needs. Verify the appropriate current records and notices for the property.
HOA / Property Owners Association	If applicable, transfer fees, resale certificates, restrictions or other association documents may be part of the transaction.
Leased / Solar / Security Equipment	Leased items or service agreements may need to be identified and addressed as part of the sale.

Best practice
If you are unsure whether something should be disclosed, do not guess. Bring the question to your REALTOR® and, when appropriate, a qualified attorney or other professional.

Title, Survey & Closing

Title Review	The title process helps identify ownership history, liens, claims, and other matters that may need to be addressed before closing.
Payoff Information	Existing mortgage or lien payoff information is gathered so the appropriate amounts can be handled at closing.
Survey	An existing survey may be usable depending on the transaction and requirements. Your title/closing professionals can advise on what is needed.
HOA / Association	If applicable, association documents, transfer information, fees, and other requirements may need to be addressed.
Closing Figures	The final settlement figures reflect the contract and transaction-specific costs, credits, prorations, payoffs, and other amounts.
Final Walkthrough	The buyer may conduct a final walkthrough to confirm the property is in the agreed condition and that agreed personal property remains.
Signing & Funding	The appropriate closing professional coordinates documents, signatures, funding, and recording according to the transaction.

Wire-fraud reminder
Never rely on an unexpected email or text message to change wiring instructions. Verify payment instructions using a trusted phone number or established contact method with the appropriate closing professional.

Title, Survey & Closing

Your estimated net proceeds are more useful than focusing on the list price alone. The final amount depends on your contract, property, loan, taxes, title/closing charges, negotiated concessions, repairs, and other transaction-specific items.

Mortgage / Lien Payoffs	Existing debt and other liens are generally addressed from closing proceeds.
Brokerage Compensation	Compensation is determined by the applicable agreement(s).
Title / Closing Charges	Transaction-specific title, escrow/closing, recording, and related charges may apply.
Tax Prorations	Property taxes and other prorated items may affect the final settlement.
HOA / Association Fees	If applicable, transfer, resale, document, or other association charges may apply.
Survey / Other Services	Certain transactions may involve survey, inspection, document, or other service costs.
Repairs / Concessions	Negotiated repairs, credits, or buyer concessions can reduce net proceeds
Other Transaction-Specific Expenses	Examples may include lease termination, vendor work, or special property requirements.

Your net sheet
Before you commit to a sale, ask for an estimated seller net sheet based on your expected price and known transaction costs. Treat it as an estimate until the final figures are prepared by the appropriate closing professionals.

Moving Resources

Use this page as a starting checklist. Vendor recommendations are provided as a convenience; sellers are free to choose their own providers.

- [ ] Get moving estimates and compare services
- [ ] Purge, sell, donate or dispose of unwanted items
- [ ] Schedule movers or moving help
- [ ] Arrange storage if needed
- [ ] Schedule deep cleaning
- [ ] Arrange junk removal or an estate sale if needed
- [ ] Transfer or disconnect utilities according to your move
- [ ] Forward mail with USPS
- [ ] Update your address with banks and financial institutions
- [ ] Update insurance and other service providers
- [ ] Update DMV and other government records as applicable
- [ ] Arrange care for children and pets on moving day
- [ ] Pack an “open first” box
- [ ] Keep important documents together and accessible
- [ ] Confirm your closing and possession timeline

Open First Box
Toilet paper • Paper towels • Hand soap • Chargers • Basic toiletries • Medications • Snacks • Change of clothes • Cleaning supplies • Trash bags • Important documents

Special Situations

Selling with Tenants	Review lease terms, notice requirements, access, timing, and buyer expectations early.
Inherited / Estate Property	Ownership, authority to sell, probate/estate matters, and documentation may need special attention.
Divorce	Coordinate the sale with the applicable legal and financial professionals and make sure all required parties are involved.
Relocation	Build the listing timeline around your move, new home, employment schedule, and possession needs.
Investment Property	Consider tenant status, leases, income/expense information, and buyer expectations.
Acreage / Farm & Ranch	Additional considerations may include wells, septic, access, outbuildings, agricultural use, easements, or land-specific information.
Septic / Well	Gather available installation, maintenance, inspection, and service records early.
Solar Panels / Leased Equipment	Review contracts and transfer/payoff requirements before listing.
Selling Before Buying	We can discuss timing strategies, contingencies, temporary housing, leasebacks, and other options with your broader plan in mind.

The earlier we know, the better we can plan.
If your sale involves a tenant, estate, divorce, relocation, solar agreement, private well/septic system, or another special circumstance, bring it up early so the right professionals and timeline can be considered.

Seller Questionnaire

1. **Property**
   Address: _____
2. **Timing**
   When would you ideally like to sell? _____
3. **Next Home**
   Are you buying another property or have housing plans? _____
4. **Exclusions**
   Anything you want excluded from the sale? _____
5. **Showings**
   How much notice do you need for showings? _____
6. **Pets**
   What is your plan for pets during showings? _____
7. **Survey**
   Do you have a copy of the survey? _____
8. **Improvements**
   What major updates or structural changes have been made? _____
9. **Water / Septic**
   Is the property on public water/sewer or private systems? _____
10. **HOA**
    Is there an HOA/property owners association? _____

Seller Questionnaire

11. **Leased Items**
    Solar, security, equipment, etc.? _____

12. R**epairs**
    Any repairs/updates planned before listing? _____

13. **Mortgage**
    Approximate payoff balance (for net-sheet planning): _____

14. **Legal Names**
    Names of all sellers as they should appear on transaction documents:_____

15. **Additional Sellers**
    Are there additional owners/sellers? _____

16. S**pecial Circumstances**
    Tenant, estate, divorce, relocation, etc.? _____

Seller FAQ

Should I replace the carpet?	Not automatically. We'll consider condition, buyer expectations, competing listings, cost, and the likely benefit before recommending a change.
Should I paint before listing?	Fresh, neutral paint can help in some homes, but it is not always necessary. Let's evaluate the condition and the market first.
Do I have to fix everything?	No. The goal is to make informed decisions. We'll prioritize visible, important, and market-relevant items rather than assuming every imperfection needs to be corrected.
Can I be home during showings?	You can discuss your preferences and showing instructions with your REALTOR®. In many cases, giving buyers space to view the property comfortably is helpful.
What if the buyer's appraisal is low?	The available options depend on the contract, financing, and circumstances. We'll review the situation and negotiate based on the information available.
When do I have to move?	Your move-out and possession timing should be coordinated with the contract and closing arrangements. Discuss your preferred timeline before accepting an offer.
Can I take my chandelier or TV mounts?	Personal property and fixtures should be addressed clearly before or in the contract. If something is excluded, disclose it and make sure it is documented appropriately.
What if the buyer wants repairs?	We'll review the request, consider the inspection findings and market context, and decide what response best protects your interests.

Post-Closing Checklist

- [ ] Keep copies of your final closing documents
- [ ] Confirm payoff / lien information is complete
- [ ] Save your settlement statement for your records
- [ ] Update your address with banks and financial institutions
- [ ] Forward mail through USPS
- [ ] Update insurance and other service providers
- [ ] Return keys, remotes, access devices and agreed items
- [ ] Confirm utility transfers or final readings
- [ ] Cancel or transfer applicable home services
- [ ] Update government records as applicable
- [ ] Secure records for warranties, repairs and improvements
- [ ] Keep your REALTOR® and closing contacts for future questions

One more thing
Your relationship with your REALTOR® does not have to end at closing. Keep the contact information for the professionals who helped you through the transaction—you may need a resource, recommendation, or real estate conversation again.

Before You Spend a Dollar

Thinking about painting?

Replacing flooring?

Updating a bathroom?

Installing a new roof?

Before you invest in preparing your home for sale, *let's talk.*

Not every improvement produces the return you might expect. I'll help you prioritize the work that is most likely to matter to buyers, fit the market, and support your overall selling strategy.



Lisa Keefe + Jennifer Keefe-Rosheisen
The Keefe Team, JLA Realty

O: 817-807-3367